CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 3

Chapters 10–18: **A Triumph of Surgery (Footprints Without Feet), The Book That Saved the Earth (Footprints Without Feet)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which of the following is a valid criticism of Horace's plan? 1

(a) it was too simple
(b) it assumed no one would appear and ignored the risk of evidence
(c) it was too cruel
(d) it involved violence

2. Wells's attitude to scientific progress in the extract is best described as: 1

(a) blindly optimistic **(b)** hostile to all science
(c) indifferent **(d)** cautious and questioning

3. Which of these best explains why the discovery about the gold spots matters? 1

(a) it ended tagging
(b) it won a medal
(c) it made butterflies bigger
(d) it overturned the assumption that they were only ornamental

4. The ending can be called a 'surprise ending' because: 1

(a) the truth about the necklace upsets the reader's expectation
(b) the husband dies
(c) the necklace is found
(d) the friend becomes poor

5. Abbas uses Bholi's story mainly to: 1

(a) teach mathematics
(b) entertain with humour
(c) describe village scenery
(d) criticise social prejudice and dowry while praising education

6. Choose the sentence with correct use of 'unless': 1

(a) Unless Martians attack, understand.
(b) Unless the Martians understood Earth, they should not attack.
(c) Unless Martians not understand, attack.
(d) Unless understand Martians, no attack.

7. The satire in the story is directed mainly at: 1

(a) dogs **(b)** vets
(c) Yorkshire **(d)** excessive, uncritical indulgence

8. The ending is 'open' in that: 1

(a) the story continues forever
(b) we imagine Hari's future after the lessons
(c) the thief is caught
(d) Anil leaves

9. The 'sixth floor' detail serves as: 1

(a) a joke **(b)** a clue to Fowler's age
(c) foreshadowing of the fatal fall **(d)** a decoration

10. Which of these best explains why Horace lowers his guard? 1

(a) the woman acts so naturally that he forgets his own illegal presence
(b) he is tired
(c) he is rich
(d) he is blind

11. Which of these shows the limits of invisibility? 1

(a) he became wise **(b)** footprints, hunger and cold remain
(c) he became rich **(d)** he could fly

12. The shift from hobby to research is marked by: 1

(a) more friends **(b)** systematic questioning and experiment
(c) bigger collections only **(d)** more spending

13. Which of the following best defines 'pathos' in the story? 1

(a) the anger at Forestier **(b)** the pity we feel for Mathilde's toil
(c) the humour in the ball **(d)** the joy of the end

14. A critic might say Bishamber is a 'flat' character because: 1

(a) he changes often **(b)** he represents only greed
(c) he is the hero **(d)** he has many sides

15. The playwright's attitude to militarism is: 1

(a) gently mocking **(b)** neutral **(c)** fearful **(d)** admiring

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. What is the significance of the train in the story? 2

17. What does the story suggest about fear? 2

18. Comment on the use of understatement. 2

19. What does the extract imply about scientific responsibility? 2

20. Comment on the importance of context (home, school, mentor) in the making of a scientist. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. What does the chapter imply about the role of play in learning? 3

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22. What does the story suggest about the nature of fate and chance? 3

23. Compare Bholi's courage with that of Hari Singh's change in 'The Thief's Story'. 3

24. Discuss the effect of exaggeration in character presentation. 3

OR

Convert into direct speech: Herriot told her that Tricki needed exercise. 3

25. Write about the narrator's tone when describing himself. 3

OR

Discuss how the story reflects the idea 'Appearances can be deceptive'. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. 'The Book That Saved the Earth' proves that ignorance can be as dangerous as malice. Discuss critically. 5

OR

Write a speech: 'Discipline is also a form of love'. 5

27. Write a dialogue between Hari and a friend who urges him to keep the money. 5

OR

Write a dialogue between Fowler and an editor who wants to publish his story about Ausable. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks

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